



# Maarij Ali

## AI Engineer

AI Engineer with experience designing and prototyping AI-powered solutions using Azure OpenAI, Azure Functions, Microsoft Power Platform and agentic workflow architectures. Experienced in building intelligent automation, conversational AI assistants, multi-step reasoning workflows and enterprise AI solution designs. Strong background in business analysis, stakeholder engagement and large-scale digital transformation programmes, supporting end-to-end delivery across multiple markets. Called to the Bar of England and Wales, bringing strong analytical thinking, communication, and problem-solving skills to stakeholder-driven environments.

## Experience

### Jul 2022 - present

Cognizant Technology Solutions | Bishopsgate, London

#### AI Trading Assistant – Agentic AI Solution Prototype (2026)

*Designed and developed an AI-powered Trading Assistant prototype aimed at reducing data-to-decision latency for commercial trading teams operating across multiple markets.*

- Designed end-to-end agentic AI architecture using Python, Azure Functions, Azure OpenAI and Microsoft Power Platform.
- Built modular reasoning engines for trading analysis, root-cause identification, recommendation generation and executive commentary workflows.
- Implemented Azure Function endpoints and Power Automate orchestration workflows to support scheduled intelligence brief delivery and conversational Q&A capabilities within Microsoft 365 services.
- Integrated Azure OpenAI to generate grounded business commentary, management summaries and contextual responses from structured trading datasets.
- Designed a Microsoft Teams conversational assistant experience and interactive React/Vite prototype demonstrating future-state user workflows.
- Produced future-state architecture covering governance, authentication, monitoring, RAG integration, LoRA-based fine-tuning approaches and enterprise deployment.
- Presented solution architecture, prototype capabilities and implementation roadmap to senior leadership.

#### BAT (British American Tobacco)

##### Business Analyst (July 24 - Feb 26)

- Supported large-scale digital and eCommerce transformation initiatives spanning multiple international markets within complex enterprise delivery environments.
- Owned the end-to-end requirements lifecycle across platform enhancements and integration initiatives, translating business requirements into structured, testable deliverables aligned with business and delivery objectives.
- Collaborated closely with architects, developers, QA teams, and business stakeholders to support solution design, delivery planning, dependency management, and release coordination within Agile delivery teams.
- Managed and prioritised backlogs within Azure DevOps, supporting sprint planning, feature refinement, delivery tracking, and alignment across multiple workstreams.
- Supported risk and issue management throughout delivery lifecycles, including defect triage, UAT coordination, and resolution tracking through to production release.
- Delivered knowledge transfer sessions and documentation to onboard new team members and ensure continuity across pods.

#### John Lewis & Partners

##### Digital Asset Management Specialist (Nov 22 - July 24)

- Supported digital asset management operations within an Adobe Experience Manager (AEM) environment, helping streamline asset workflows and improve the accessibility and organisation of digital content.
- Utilised Jira and ServiceNow to manage and track DAM-related tasks, defects, incidents, and change requests, working closely with cross-functional teams to support the delivery and deployment of digital asset solutions.
- Worked closely with stakeholders and technical teams to support DAM processes and ensure alignment between operational requirements and platform capabilities.

#### Technical Training Programme

##### Programmer in Training (July 22 - Nov 22)

- Completed an intensive technical training programme at Cognizant, gaining hands-on exposure to frontend and backend technologies including HTML, CSS, JavaScript, React.js, Node.js, and MongoDB.
- Built a strong understanding of software development fundamentals, Agile ways of working, and problem-solving within collaborative delivery environments.

### Apr 2022 - Jul 2022

#### Capital Selection | Mayfair, London Research Associate

- Supported recruitment activity for financial services and technology-focused clients within a fast-paced, KPI-driven environment, working across candidate sourcing, market research, and client coordination, gaining exposure to fintech and investment-related sectors.
- Contributed to lead generation and business development activity while developing strong communication and stakeholder engagement skills.

### Earlier Career Experience (2015–2022)

Held customer-facing, sales, marketing and operational roles across retail and professional services environments, developing strong communication and commercial awareness skills.

## Contact

+44 7930 349 506

maarij-ali@outlook.com

www.linkedin.com/in/maarij-ali-76b15019a

London, United Kingdom

## Education

2022

### LLM Bar Vocational Studies with Corporate Specialism

City Law School, London

Merit (with distinctions in advocacy, opinion writing, legal drafting, conference skills)  
Completed a dissertation assessing authorities/ precedent within the unfair prejudice jurisdiction in company law

2020

### LLB Bachelor of Laws with Honors

City Law School, London

Class II Upper Division

2017

### A-Levels

Sixth Form College, Colchester

Psychology (B), Sociology (B), English Language (C)

2015

### Honywood Community Science School

5 A's & 5 B's, including Maths, English & Sciences

## Skills

#### AI & Automation:

Agentic AI, Azure OpenAI, Azure Functions, Power Platform, Prompt Engineering, Conversational AI, AI Solution Design, Multi-Step Reasoning Workflows, RAG Concepts, LoRA & Fine-Tuning Concepts, LLM Evaluation & Guardrails

#### Business Analysis:

Requirements Management, Backlog Refinement, User Stories & Acceptance Criteria, Stakeholder Management, UAT & Defect Management, Agile / Scrum, Azure DevOps, Multi-Market Delivery, Platform Migration & Transformation

#### Tools & Technologies:

Python, React, JavaScript, Microsoft 365, Azure DevOps, Magento/Adobe Commerce, AEM, Jira, ServiceNow

## Achievements/ Interests

- Member & Barrister of the Honourable Society of Lincoln's Inn.
- Recognised for academic achievement, including a 'Best in Year' award and a Silver award in the UK Mathematics Challenge.
- Strong interest in financial markets and emerging technologies, including AI-driven solutions, automation, and digital innovation.

## Languages

English (native)

Urdu (spoken)